

# Michael L. Wasserstein

michael.wasserstein@utah.edu  
(203) 519-5503

[personal website](#)  
[LinkedIn](#)

---

## EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Atmospheric Sciences, University of Utah — Expected November 2026

M.S. in Atmospheric Sciences, University of Utah — August 2023

B.A. in Physics with Honors (Minors in Mathematics and Spanish), GPA: 3.74; Middlebury College — May 2021

## SKILLS

**Programming:** Python (primary), R, MATLAB, Mathematica, Fortran

**Modeling & Tools:** Weather Research and Forecasting (WRF) Model, Cloud Model 1 (CM1), CR-SIM, LAGRANTO, xarray, pandas, numpy, scikit-learn

**Languages:** English (native), Spanish

## EXPERIENCE

**Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Utah — 2021–Present

- Examined vertically profiling radar and PARSIVEL disdrometer data to understand characteristics of storms passing over basin-and-range orography.
- Launched radiosondes and operated X-band weather radar during S<sup>2</sup>noCliME (Steamboat Springs, CO) and SNOWSCAPE (Huntsville, UT) field campaigns.
- Developed climatology of cool-season storms in Utah’s Wasatch range. ([paper](#))
- Developed quasi-real time data dashboards to support operations in [Little Cottonwood Canyon](#) and for the [SNOWSCAPE field campaign](#).

**Visiting Scientist**, National Center for Atmospheric Research (NCAR) — Summer 2024

- Conducted WRF large-eddy simulations of northern Utah winter storms and managed and analyzed >5 TB of model output data.

**Graduate Teaching Assistant**, University of Utah — Spring 2023

- Assisted with instruction, content development, and grading for a 300-student online asynchronous general education course.

**Undergraduate Researcher**, Middlebury College — 2020–2021

- Conducted WRF simulations to examine the influences of microphysics parameterizations on a winter storm in Vermont.
- Derived and conducted numerical simulations of the Navier-Stokes equations in a rotating reference frame.

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Wasserstein, M.L., Evans, A.L., Veals, P.G., Kingsmill, D.E., and Steenburgh, W.J.: Orographic Influences on Precipitation in a Continental Mountain Environment as Observed by Mountain and Valley Profiling Radars. *Mon. Wea. Rev.*, in review.

Wasserstein, M.L. and Steenburgh, W.J., 2024: Diverse Characteristics of Extreme Orographic Snowfall Events in Little Cottonwood Canyon, Utah. *Mon. Wea. Rev.*, 152, 945–966, <https://journals.ametsoc.org/view/journals/mwre/152/4/MWR-D-23-0206.1>.

## HONORS AND AWARDS

- Massey Family Award for Data Science, University of Utah (2026)
- Outstanding Student Presentation Award, AMS 21st Conference on Mountain Meteorology (2024)
- NCAR ASP Graduate Visitor Program Fellowship (2024)